BMC – Avenor

Name: Avenor Team (Congressional App Challenge)

Free iPhone study app — planner + focus timer + spaced-repetition review — for students in 8th grade through college

Customer Problems

• **Hard to start & stay focused** — phones and notifications pull students off homework; they procrastinate, then rush.

• **Forget what they studied** — rereading and cramming the night before means most of it is gone by the test.

• **Overwhelmed keeping track** of assignments, tests and 5–7 classes spread across paper, LMS and several apps.

• **Parents/teachers** struggle to build study habits without paying for 3+ apps or sharing kids' data.

Existing Alternatives

Direct – MyStudyLife, myHomework (planners); Forest (focus timer); Quizlet, Anki (flashcards)

Indirect – Paper planners, Google Calendar/Classroom, iPhone Reminders, Notion, sticky notes

Solution

A **free iPhone app** that combines a student planner, a distraction-free focus timer and a spaced-repetition review coach.

It **picks what to work on next**, runs the study session, then turns what you learned into review cards.

Features: one-sentence quick add, Focus Now pick, Study Mode, Review cards, kind streaks.

Key Metrics

• # of App Store downloads

• # of weekly active students

• # of focus sessions & minutes focused per student/week

• # of review cards created & reviewed

• # of students on a 7+ day streak (retention)

• # of tips vs. the $99 yearly fee

• # of 4-star+ App Store ratings

Unique Value Proposition

Know what to do next
Open Avenor and tap Start. It ranks your work by due date and priority so you never waste time deciding — one tap from phone to studying.

Study once, remember longer
Every focus session ends with a 30-second self-quiz that becomes a review card, brought back after 1, 2, 4, 8 and 16 days — right before you'd forget it.

Free & private forever
No ads, no subscriptions, no account. Every feature is unlocked and all data stays on your phone — replacing 3 paid apps with 1 free one.

Customer Relationships

• Congressional App Challenge showcase, district office & House.gov listing

• School announcements, teacher & counselor recommendations, back-to-school nights

• Student clubs (NHS, FBLA, TSA) and study-tip shorts on TikTok, Instagram & YouTube

• In-app: helpful reminders, kind streaks, feedback email; word of mouth

Channels

Direct – Team website with QR-code posters and live demos at our schools

Indirect – Apple App Store (free download); Congressional App Challenge / House.gov app gallery; teachers sharing the link in class

Customer Segments

Customer/User – U.S. students in 8th grade through college (ages ~13–22) who own an iPhone

Customer – Parents/guardians and teachers/counselors who recommend the app and may leave an optional tip

Geographic – Starting in our Congressional district's middle schools, high schools and community colleges; then nationwide

Early Adopter

15-year-old honors sophomore with 6 classes plus a sport/club. Owns an iPhone, loses evenings to short videos, crams the night before tests, and wants better grades without paying for or juggling three separate apps.

Cost Structure

Startup – App design & development by the student team (volunteer, $0); Mac + Xcode already owned or in school lab (Xcode is free); icon, screenshots & website made in-house ($0)

COGS – **$0 per user**: no servers, cloud database, push service or analytics. Data, reminders and review scheduling all run on the student's own phone, so 10 users or 100,000 cost the same.

SG&A – Apple Developer Program $99/yr (school/nonprofit fee waiver can make it $0); website on free hosting ($0) + optional domain ~$12/yr; printed flyers ~$20; Apple keeps 15% of tips

Total: about $99–$131 per year — possibly $0

Revenue Streams

• **Free to install, free to use** — no ads, subscriptions, paywalls or data sales.

• **Optional in-app tip jar**: $0.99 / $2.99 / $4.99 one-time tips through Apple In-App Purchase. Paid by users or parents; tips unlock nothing.

• Apple's Small Business Program keeps 15%, so ~$0.84 of a $0.99 tip reaches the team. About 40 average tips ($2.99) cover the $99 yearly fee.

• *Not revenue:* contest recognition, school sponsorship or grants (investment/support, not sales).

Avenor – Alignment & UX Laws

How each segment's problem maps to a value proposition, and how eight UX laws shape the app (see DESIGN.md in the source for detail).

Segment	Problem (pain)	Value proposition	Feature that delivers it
Students 8th–college	Can't start / get distracted	Know what to do next	Focus Now pick + one-tap Study Mode, hold-to-quit, come-back nudge
Students 8th–college	Forget what they studied	Study once, remember longer	30-second recall card after each session; Leitner spaced review (1-2-4-8-16 days)
Students 8th–college	Overwhelmed tracking work	Know what to do next	Quick add (“Bio essay fri 45m !”), auto-grouped lists, week calendar, class colors
Parents & teachers	Paying for several apps; data privacy	Free & private forever	All features free, no account, on-device data, optional tips only

UX law	What it says	How Avenor uses it
Jakob's Law	Users expect apps to work like the ones they already know.	Standard iOS tab bar, swipe right = done / left = delete, sheets, SF Symbols, Undo toast instead of scary alerts.
Fitts's Law	Bigger, closer targets are faster to hit.	56 pt full-width Start buttons in the thumb zone; 44 pt minimum targets. Reversed for quitting: ending a session early is a 1.5-second hold.
Hick's Law	More choices mean slower decisions.	4 tabs instead of 5; Today shows ONE recommended task; 3 session lengths; 2 review answers (“Not yet” / “Got it”).
Miller's Law	Working memory holds about 7 ± 2 items.	Max 3 “up next” tasks, 5 focus choices, 20-card review sets; tasks chunked by due day; big tasks shown as “3 sessions”.
Tesler's Law	Some complexity can't be removed — the app should absorb it.	Natural-language quick add, automatic priority ranking with a reason, default reminder times, auto class colors and grade-based goals.
Aesthetic-Usability	Attractive design feels easier to use.	One calm dark theme, consistent class colors, smooth motion and success haptics.
Peak-End Rule	Experiences are judged by their peak and their end.	Celebration screen after every session, “that still counts” for early exits, review summary, evening “Today's wrap” with tomorrow's first task.
Von Restorff Effect	The item that stands out gets remembered.	Only the gradient Focus Now / Ready-to-review card is bright; red is reserved for overdue and high-priority items.

Study science built in: retrieval practice (self-quiz after each session), spacing (Leitner boxes), the generation effect (students write their own questions), goal-gradient progress rings, and a **kind streak** that forgives one missed day per week of streak. **Guardrails:** no ads, feeds, random rewards or data collection; tips never unlock features.